

# 12 Nature

## Vocabulary 1: climate

**A** Look at the three dictionary extracts. Which is for *weather*, which is for *climate* and which is for *season*? Write the words in the spaces.

\_\_\_\_\_ *n* 1 [singular, U] the conditions at a particular place and time, such as sun, rain, wind and temperature.

\_\_\_\_\_ *n* 1 [C] the typical weather conditions in a particular area.

\_\_\_\_\_ *n* [C] 1 any of the four main periods in the year: winter, spring, summer or autumn.

**B** Write the seasons below.

1. grips \_\_\_\_\_ 2. mumres \_\_\_\_\_ 3. nutmua \_\_\_\_\_ 4. newrit \_\_\_\_\_

**C** Check the highlighted words and phrases in these sentences and tick the sentences that are true for you. Then compare with a partner.

1. In my country there are **four seasons**.
2. In my country there is a **dry season** and a **rainy season**.
3. The weather in my country is very **changeable**. It can be sunny one day and cold and wet the next.
4. The winters in my country are **mild**. It is never really cold.
5. We often have **extreme weather** in my country. Sometimes it is very hot and sometimes it rains for four or five days.

## Vocabulary 2: weather conditions

**A** Check the highlighted words and match the sentences with the pictures. Some pictures match with more than one sentence.

1. It's very **hot** and **sunny**. \_\_\_\_\_
2. It's very **windy**. \_\_\_\_\_
3. It's **freezing cold**. \_\_\_\_\_
4. There's a **storm**. / It's **stormy**. \_\_\_\_\_
5. There's a **clear blue sky**. \_\_\_\_\_
6. There's a lot of **snow**. / It's **snowing**. \_\_\_\_\_
7. It's very **foggy**. / There's a lot of **fog**. \_\_\_\_\_
8. It's a bit **cloudy**. / There's quite a lot of **cloud**. \_\_\_\_\_
9. It's **raining heavily**. / There's a lot of **rain**. \_\_\_\_\_
10. There's **thunder** and **lightning**. \_\_\_\_\_



**Grammar check**

We use *there is / there are* with nouns. *There is a lot of rain. / There are a lot of clouds.*

We use *it is* with adjectives and verbs. *It's sunny. / It's raining.*

Most weather nouns can be made into adjectives by adding a 'y'.  
*sunny / rainy / cloudy / stormy, etc.*

**Watch out!**  
**typical errors**

It is a lot of rain. **X**

There is windy today. **X**

**B** Mark these adjectives (G) good weather or (B) bad weather.

- |                    |                    |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| 1. nice _____      | 2. lovely _____    |
| 3. horrible _____  | 4. miserable _____ |
| 5. beautiful _____ | 6. awful _____     |

**Speaking 1: talking about climate and weather****A** Talk with a partner about the photos on the opposite page like this.

*It's really horrible weather. There's a storm and it's raining heavily.*

**B** Now talk about the weather in any countries that you have visited.**Speaking 2: answering the question properly****A**  Think about how you could answer these questions from the first part of the speaking exam. Then listen to some students and tick the speaker who gives a better answer.

- |                                                         |                 |                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. What sort of climate does the area you live in have? | speaker 1 _____ | speaker 2 _____ |
| 2. Tell me about the weather in your country.           | speaker 1 _____ | speaker 2 _____ |
| 3. Is there one season that you especially like?        | speaker 1 _____ | speaker 2 _____ |
| 4. Do you do the same things in summer as in winter?    | speaker 1 _____ | speaker 2 _____ |



**Exam tip:** When people ask a yes/no question, they usually expect more than just a yes/no answer. If the examiner asks you a yes/no question, he is inviting you to speak.

**B** Answer the questions in Exercise A with a partner.**Speaking 3: talking about temperature****A** Check the highlighted words and complete these sentences so that they are true for you. Cross out the extra words.

- The **temperature** on a hot summer day can **reach** \_\_\_\_°.
- At night in winter, the temperature can **fall to** \_\_\_\_° / **minus** \_\_\_\_° / \_\_\_\_° **below zero**.
- The **highest temperature** I have ever experienced was \_\_\_\_°.
- The **lowest temperature** I have ever experienced was \_\_\_\_°.

**Pronunciation check**

Notice how the *-ture* at the end of *temperature* is pronounced.

Here are some more words that have the same ending.

 Listen and then practise saying them.

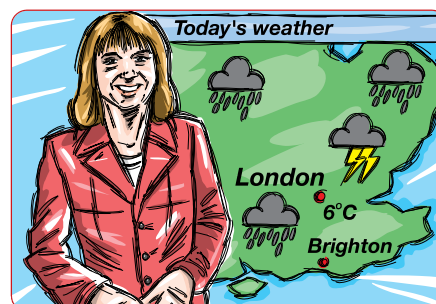
- |            |           |              |            |
|------------|-----------|--------------|------------|
| 1. picture | 2. nature | 3. adventure | 4. culture |
|------------|-----------|--------------|------------|

**Listening 1: a weather forecast****A** Look at the picture and answer the questions with a partner.

1. Who is the woman and what is she doing?
2. What are the symbols you can see on the map?
3. What do you think the woman will say about the weather?

**B** Listen to the weather forecast and check your predictions.**C** Listen again and complete the notes. Use no more than two words for each answer.

1. People in the south-east can \_\_\_\_\_ very bad weather.
2. In the morning, there will be \_\_\_\_\_.
3. There may be \_\_\_\_\_ along the coast.
4. The weather should \_\_\_\_\_ a little as the day goes on.
5. \_\_\_\_\_ will be low for the time of year.

**Listening 2: an everyday conversation****A** Look at the picture and answer the questions with a partner.

1. Who are the people in the picture?
2. What do you think they are talking about?

**B** Listen to the conversation and check your predictions.**C** Listen again and complete the lines. Use no more than two words for each answer.

1. Raining? It's absolutely \_\_\_\_\_ down.
2. It's really \_\_\_\_\_ out there too.
3. Never mind. They say it's going to \_\_\_\_\_ later on.

**Listening 3: recognizing register****A** Talk with a partner. How is the language used in the conversation different from the language used in the weather forecast?

**Exam tip:** The Listening Module has four sections. The speaker(s) will sometimes use formal language – a talk or a lecture. The speaker(s) will sometimes use informal language – a conversation or a talk to classmates. You will understand more if you recognize the register that the speaker is using.

**B** Look at the tapescript on pages 304 and 305. Highlight words and phrases that are formal or informal.

## Listening 4: practise recognizing register

**A** Listen to the four extracts and match them with the descriptions below.

- |                                                  |              |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 1. an informal conversation between two speakers | Extract ____ |
| 2. a formal talk given by one speaker            | Extract ____ |
| 3. an informal talk given by one speaker         | Extract ____ |
| 4. a formal conversation between two speakers    | Extract ____ |

**B** Listen again to each extract and complete the tasks below.

**Extract 1:** For questions 1–3, complete the sentences. Use no more than two words for each answer.

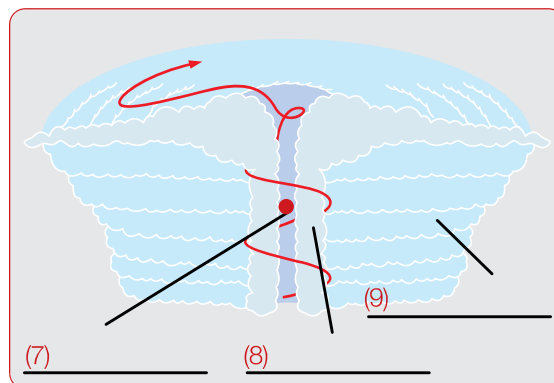
- People in Libya know about sandstorms because they live close to the \_\_\_\_\_.
- Sandstorms occur when sand is carried by a \_\_\_\_\_.
- A sandstorm looks like a big wall or \_\_\_\_\_ of sand coming towards you.

**Extract 2:** For questions 4–6, choose the correct answer a, b or c.

- The first speaker thinks that Egypt will ...  
a. not be hot enough.    b. be quite hot.    c. be too hot.
- During the hottest part of the day, the second speaker plans to ...  
a. go sightseeing.    b. relax at her hotel.    c. go to sleep.
- The first speaker ...  
a. thinks she went somewhere at the wrong time of year.  
b. does not want to go back to Morocco.  
c. only travels in spring or autumn.

**Extract 3:** For questions 7–9, label the diagram. Use no more than two words for each answer.

**Extract 4:** For questions 10–12, complete the notes a student has made. Use one word for each answer.



Floods caused by rising water level.

Can be (10) \_\_\_\_\_ - happening suddenly or creeping - happening slowly.

Floods caused by heavy rainfall or by (11) \_\_\_\_\_ melting.

Floods usually cause damage but can be good for soil - (12) \_\_\_\_\_ grow better after flood water.

**C** Check the key on page 271. How many questions did you answer correctly?

**D** Tick the sentences about the listening task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

- I recognized formal and informal language quite easily.
- Recognizing the register helped me understand and complete the tasks.
- I am pleased with how many questions I answered correctly.

### Key vocabulary in context

Mark each sentence below (F) formal or (I) informal.

- Conditions should improve later in the day. \_\_\_\_
- Floods occur when there is a large amount of rainfall. \_\_\_\_
- Most parts of the country can expect a cold night. \_\_\_\_
- They say things will get better later on. \_\_\_\_
- So, what happens when there's lots of rain? Does it flood? \_\_\_\_
- They say it's going to be a bit chilly tonight. \_\_\_\_

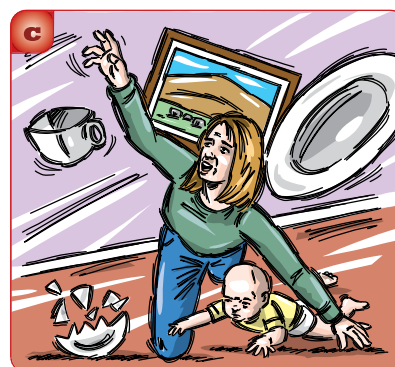
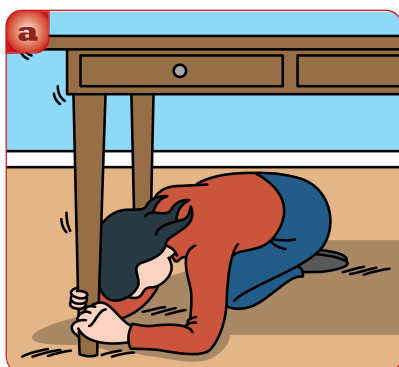
**Reading 1: preparing to read**

- A** Look at the picture and talk to a partner. What has happened?
- B** In which parts of the world do earthquakes occur? Why do they occur?
- C** Look at these three images. Match each to one of the text headings below.



1. What to do when there's an earthquake
2. My earthquake terror
3. The science of earthquakes

\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_



- D** Check these words and phrases. Which of the headings and images do they relate to? Compare your ideas with a partner.

|            |                     |                 |                |          |
|------------|---------------------|-----------------|----------------|----------|
| grab       | fault lines         | stay calm       | release energy | scramble |
| take cover | avoid being injured | tectonic plates | rush           |          |

**Reading 2: different types of text**

- A** Skim each extract below and match it with the correct heading and image.

1. As soon as I realized the ground was shaking, I rushed into the bathroom, where my little boy was in the bath. I knew that he was in a place that was very unsafe – under a window with a huge piece of glass right above his head. We had practised what to do in case of a quake and we knew where we would be safest. Unfortunately, there were no safe places inside the house and we had to try to get out to the garage as quickly as we could. \_\_\_\_
2. The Earth has four layers. The two top layers make up the thin outer surface of our planet. This outer surface consists of many pieces, tectonic plates, which move around slowly over thousands of years. Sometimes, when these plates collide, they push rock upwards to form mountains. At other times, the edges of the plates, the plate boundaries, become locked when they collide and they release a huge amount of energy that results in an earthquake. Almost all earthquakes occur along these plate boundaries, which are known as faults or fault lines. \_\_\_\_

3. If you are indoors, drop down to the floor. Take cover under a strong table or other suitable piece of furniture. Hold on to it tightly and move with it if necessary. Remain in the same position until the ground stops shaking and it is safe to move. Stay clear of windows, fireplaces and heavy furniture or appliances that may fall over. Stay inside to avoid being injured by falling glass or bricks. If you are in a crowded area, take cover where you are. Stay calm and encourage others to do the same. \_\_\_\_\_

**B** Now skim the second extract from each text and match them to the extracts in Exercise A.

1. If you are driving, stop if it is safe, but stay inside your vehicle. Stay away from bridges and tunnels. Move your car as far away from other traffic as possible. Avoid stopping under trees, lamp posts, power lines, signs or anything else that may fall down onto your vehicle. \_\_\_\_\_
2. I grabbed Daniel in my arms and scrambled through the house towards the back door. Before we could make it, a bigger shock hit us and threw us to the floor. I tried to protect my son the best I could as plates and glasses flew around and pictures crashed down from the walls. \_\_\_\_\_
3. An earthquake has three stages. Firstly, there are small earthquakes, called foreshocks, which occur in the same place as the larger earthquake that follows. Scientists do not know that an earthquake is a foreshock until the larger earthquake occurs. Then there is the main part of the earthquake, which is called the main shock. Finally, the main shock is always followed by aftershocks. These smaller earthquakes occur in the same place as the main shock. Depending on the size of the main shock, aftershocks can continue for weeks, months and even years after the main shock. \_\_\_\_\_

**C** Answer these questions about the three texts with a partner.

1. Which text has a lot of technical words?
2. Which text has examples of past tenses?
3. Which text has a lot of imperatives (verb forms that tell you to do something)?
4. Which text has more informal words and phrases, especially dramatic verbs?
5. Which text uses only the present simple?
6. Which text has examples of conditional structures?



**Exam tip:** In the Reading Module, you will need to read different types of text, and you need to be able to recognize them quickly. Notice the different styles of text and the type of language that is. The design of a text and pictures and diagrams help you to quickly recognize the type of text you are reading.

### Reading 3: practice with different types of text

**A** Read 'The science of earthquakes' again carefully and answer these questions.

For questions 1–3, decide which of these statements about earthquakes are true. Choose three answers from A–F.

- A When tectonic plates move, there are always earthquakes.
- B Mountains are formed when there is an earthquake.
- C Earthquakes are likely to occur in the same place.
- D Foreshocks occur before there is a main shock.
- E People always know that a main shock will follow a foreshock.
- F Aftershocks go on for longer if the earthquake has been very big.

1. \_\_\_\_\_ 2. \_\_\_\_\_ 3. \_\_\_\_\_

**B** Read 'What to do when there's an earthquake' again carefully and answer these questions.

For questions 4–9, complete the summary with words and phrases from the box.

|         |       |         |        |       |          |
|---------|-------|---------|--------|-------|----------|
| leave   | quick | indoors | people | under | run away |
| traffic | place | table   | floor  | calm  | outside  |

The best place to be when there is an earthquake is on the (4) \_\_\_\_\_. You will be safer if you can find a suitable piece of strong furniture to hide under. Do not try to go (5) \_\_\_\_\_ as you could be hit by falling bricks and flying glass. If there are a lot of (6) \_\_\_\_\_ around, do not try to run away. Make sure everyone is as (7) \_\_\_\_\_ as possible. If you are driving, you should stop, but do not (8) \_\_\_\_\_ your vehicle. Do not stop in any (9) \_\_\_\_\_ where something could fall and crush your vehicle.

**C** Read 'My earthquake terror' again carefully and answer these questions.

For questions 10–13, decide if the information given below agrees with the information given in the text. Write (T) true, (F) false or (NG) not given.

10. There was a window above the bath in the woman's house. \_\_\_\_\_
11. The woman knew her family would be safer in the garage. \_\_\_\_\_
12. The woman carried her son through the house. \_\_\_\_\_
13. The woman and her son were hit by flying glass. \_\_\_\_\_

**D** Check the key on page 271. How many questions did you answer correctly?

**E** Tick the sentences about the reading task that are true for you and think about how you can answer more questions correctly next time.

1. I find it quite easy to recognize different types of text.
2. Recognizing the different text types helped me to answer questions.
3. I find some types of text easier to read than others.
4. I am happy with how many of the questions I answered correctly.

### Key vocabulary in context

Match these dramatic verbs with their definitions.

- |             |                             |
|-------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. rush     | a. move with difficulty     |
| 2. scramble | b. fall and make a noise    |
| 3. grab     | c. move as fast as possible |
| 4. crash    | d. take quickly             |

Do the same with these more formal verbs and definitions.

- |               |                                               |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1. consist of | a. allow to be free                           |
| 2. collide    | b. move towards each other and hit each other |
| 3. release    | c. stay in the same place                     |
| 4. remain     | d. to be formed from certain things           |

**WB** For focus on reading skills, go to Workbook page 34.

**Writing 1: preparing to write**

**A** Look at the two pictures and answer the questions with a partner.

1. What animals can you see in the two pictures?
2. Where are the animals in the two pictures? How are their lives different?
3. Do you think the animals are happier in either of the two environments?

**B** Talk with the same partner. Answer these questions.

1. Do you have a zoo in your town or city? If not, where is the nearest zoo to your hometown?
2. Which animals can you see there?
3. Do you go there often? Do you enjoy going to zoos generally?

**C** Look at the instructions for a writing task below. Highlight the key words and make sure you understand what you have to do.

As part of a class assignment, you have been asked to write about the following topic:

Some people think that zoos are cruel and that animals should be left in their natural environment. Others say that zoos are important because they are the only place that most children will ever see real wild animals.

What is your opinion on this issue?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your experience. Write about 250 words.

**Writing 2: deciding what to say**

**A** Discuss in small groups. Brainstorm some points that you could make in the composition. Organize your points in the columns below.

| Zoos<br>+                                             | Zoos<br>- | Natural environment<br>+ | Natural environment<br>- |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| only place that children<br>can see real wild animals |           |                          |                          |

**B** Look at these points that students made when discussing the issue. Which one of each pair of options do you think you will hear?

1. People see animals that they will probably never see in **the jungle / the wild**, like tigers and elephants.
2. Safaris are really **expensive / dangerous** and you don't see all the animals you want to see.
3. It's better to see an animal on TV in its natural **environment / place** than see it in a **little cage / big field** at the zoo looking miserable.
4. Animals don't **grow as big / live as long** in a zoo as they do in the wild.
5. Children shout and even throw things. Animals **suffer from stress / attack them**.
6. These days, animals are in big cages and they can climb and **run around / hunt**.
7. In big wildlife parks, lions are **forced / free** to walk around.
8. Some species of animal would **multiply / become extinct** if there were no zoos. Zoos help them to **develop / survive** and keep them safe.
9. One day, zoos may be the only place that many types of animal **exist / are happy**.

**C**  Listen to the discussion and circle the option you hear.

### Writing 3: practise writing the main part of a composition

**A** Read the introduction and concluding paragraph of this composition.

There are zoos in most big cities all round the world, and thousands of people visit them. Nearly everybody goes to a zoo as a child, and it is probably the only time that they see real wild animals. Although most people like going to zoos, they understand that the animals are not in their natural environment and may not be happy. Some people even think that zoos are cruel and should be closed.

In my opinion, there is a need for zoos so that children can see real animals and not just read about them in books. However, the zoos should be modern and the animals well cared for. Their cages should be big enough that they can run around. The best solution would be to have more big wildlife parks where animals are in an environment like their natural one.

**B** Think about which points you want to make in the two main paragraphs. Make sure each paragraph has a purpose.

**C** Write the two paragraphs. You should spend about 25 minutes on this.

**D** Compare your composition with other students.

**WB**  Go to Workbook page 35 for the writing task.

## Speaking

**A** Look at these possible questions from the third part of the Speaking Module. Check any words that you don't know.

1. Do you believe the world climate is changing? \_\_\_\_
2. Is the climate changing in your country? \_\_\_\_
3. Do you think that global warming is a serious threat to our planet? \_\_\_\_
4. Do you think people are to blame for destroying the world's natural environment? \_\_\_\_
5. Should people do more to protect animals that are in danger of becoming extinct? \_\_\_\_

**B** Mark each question (E) easy to answer or (D) difficult to answer. Then compare with a partner.

**C**  Listen to some students and match the answers they give to the questions in Exercise B.

Speaker 1 \_\_\_\_ Speaker 2 \_\_\_\_ Speaker 3 \_\_\_\_ Speaker 4 \_\_\_\_ Speaker 5 \_\_\_\_



**Exam tip:** Remember – you can give simple answers to complex questions. The examiner does not expect you to be a scientist or politician! He/she is interested only in your English.

**D** Practise asking and answering the questions in Exercise A with a partner.

## Vocabulary

**A** Answer these questions with words from the unit. Write the answers in your notebook if you need to practise spelling.

1. Which season is usually the coldest?
2. How do we describe weather that is not too hot and not too cold?
3. What is the noise that you hear during a storm?
4. What is the flash of electricity that you see during a storm?
5. How do we describe the weather when we can't see properly?
6. Which word describes animals that do not exist anymore?

**B** Complete these sentences with words from the unit. Some letters are given to help you.

1. When the water level rises, there may be a f \_\_\_\_ \_.
2. A hu \_\_\_\_ \_ or an e \_\_\_\_ \_ q \_\_\_\_ \_ can destroy a whole city.
3. Another way to say a minus temperature is b \_\_\_\_ \_ z \_\_\_\_ \_.
4. An informal word for very cold is f \_\_\_\_ \_ and an informal word for very hot is b \_\_\_\_ \_.
5. Animals are usually happier in their n \_\_\_\_ \_ en \_\_\_\_ \_.

**C** Correct the spelling mistakes in the words below.

- |                     |                    |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| 1. wether _____     | 2. autum _____     |
| 3. tempriture _____ | 4. occer _____     |
| 5. damidge _____    | 6. prviously _____ |
| 7. releese _____    | 8. rremain _____   |
| 9. servive _____    |                    |

## Errors

**A** There are errors in all of these sentences. Correct them.

1. It was a big storm last night.
2. Do you think a weather will be nice?
3. It's raining very heavy outside.
4. At night, the temperature can fall under ten degrees.
5. It's absolutely hot today.
6. Floods usually make a lot of damage.

## Exam Practice

## 12

## Listening

**A** You will hear someone talking to some students about how to stay safe when there is lightning. Look at the notes below carefully before you listen.

For questions 1–10, complete this student's notes. Use no more than three words or a number for each answer.

Don't go outside or stand by the window.

Lightning can strike (1) \_\_\_\_\_ from storm centre.

Try counting seconds between thunder and lightning - more than (2) \_\_\_\_\_ is safe.

Cancel planned outdoor activities, like (3) \_\_\_\_\_ or golf, and stay away from

(4) \_\_\_\_\_ - it conducts electricity!

#### If outside in storm

Find a (5) \_\_\_\_\_ or shelter in your car.

Trees, bus stops, etc., do not give enough (6) \_\_\_\_\_.

No umbrellas in open spaces and definitely no (7) \_\_\_\_\_!

If doing s/th in water, get to dry land.

#### If at home

Don't take a bath or shower - lightning passes quickly through (8) \_\_\_\_\_.

Unplug electrical appliances.

If light goes out, use a torch. Don't light (9) \_\_\_\_\_ inside house.

Try to stay inside or under cover for (10) \_\_\_\_\_ after the storm passes.

**B** You will hear an English family talking about their holiday options. Read the statements carefully before you listen.

For questions 11–16, mark each of the statements on the following page with one of the following abbreviations.

M mother

F father

J Justin – the son

E Ellie – the daughter

11. He/she doesn't want to go somewhere hot. \_\_\_\_\_
12. He/she doesn't want to visit a place where there are a lot of people. \_\_\_\_\_
13. He/she doesn't want to go somewhere cold. \_\_\_\_\_
14. He/she wants to see a big city. \_\_\_\_\_
15. He/she doesn't want to go somewhere where it's raining. \_\_\_\_\_
16. He/she doesn't want to spend a lot of time travelling. \_\_\_\_\_

**C** You will hear a lecturer talking about avalanches. Look carefully at the questions and at the diagram and box of words.

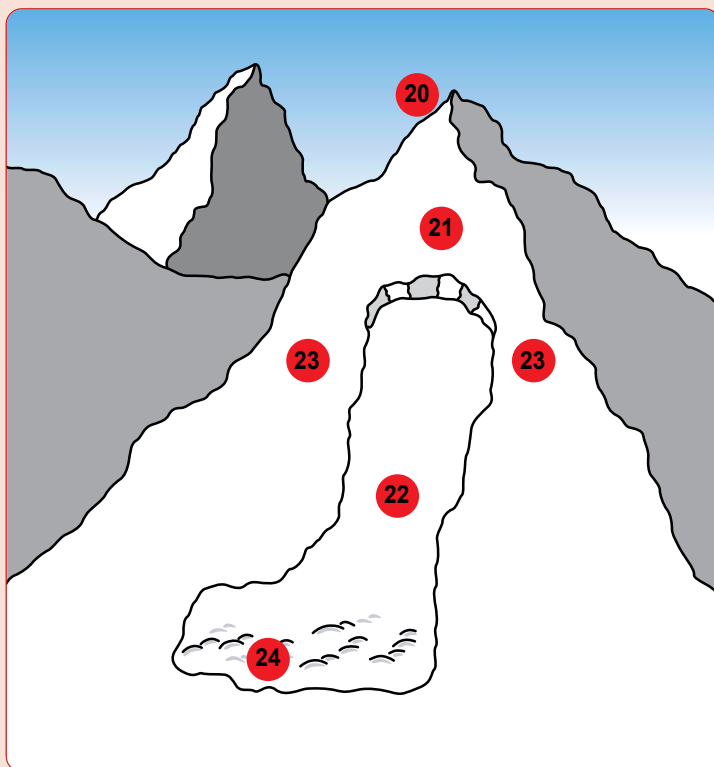
For questions 17–19, complete the notes. Use no more than two words for each answer.

17. Loose, wet snow is dangerous because it is \_\_\_\_\_.
18. The person who starts the avalanche usually becomes \_\_\_\_\_ of it.
19. Avalanches are not started by \_\_\_\_\_.

For questions 20–24, match some of the words A–H in the box with the numbers on the diagram. Write the letters in the spaces.

- |   |               |
|---|---------------|
| A | track         |
| B | debris toe    |
| C | start zone    |
| D | end zone      |
| E | top point     |
| F | trigger       |
| G | avalanche bed |
| H | flanks        |

20. \_\_\_\_\_ 21. \_\_\_\_\_ 22. \_\_\_\_\_ 23. \_\_\_\_\_ 24. \_\_\_\_\_



**Exam tip:** Look at the tapescript for each of the extracts. Notice the different register that is used in each.